

# Meeting Notes - 23 February 2026

## B2S Meeting Notes

--Date:-- 23-02-2026

--Topic:-- Product registration, OCR, image handling, and prototype scope

### 1. Current Workflow

Buy2Sell's workflow appears to have two main stages:

1. --Workshop sorting--

- Items are checked to determine whether they are worth registering.

2. --Registration--

- Product information is entered into their system.
- The system includes fields for product metadata, condition, quantity, pricing, storage, and sales information.

A previous project explored the use of stationary cameras, such as webcams. Phone-based capture has not yet been tested, but using a phone camera seems like the most practical approach because modern phones already include strong camera functionality and support useful libraries.

### 2. Competitor Approach

Competitors reportedly take multiple images of products using a turntable setup. These images are likely used to improve product presentation and possibly support resale listings on platforms such as eBay.

Buy2Sell also resells products through eBay.

### 3. Image and OCR Requirements

The system should support multiple images per item.

This is important because:

- Some labels may be split across several images.
- Some products may require multiple angles.
- OCR results may need to be combined from several photos.
- Barcode, label, and product-description information may appear in different images.

The app should be able to process multiple images and extract relevant information from all of them.

### 4. AI / Vision-Language Model Usage

A vision-language model should be used to generate descriptions based on product images.

Only fields that the AI can realistically answer from the image should be exposed to the vision-language model. Fields requiring business logic, manual judgment, or internal system knowledge should not be treated as AI-generated unless there is enough information available.

Possible AI-supported fields include:

- Manufacturer
- Product number
- Product text
- EAN / UPC
- Country of origin
- Condition notes, if visually observable
- External notes, if based on visible damage or wear

Fields such as price, storage position, internal notes, status, or item group may require manual entry or system-side logic.

## 5. Search Features

Nice-to-have functionality:

- Image search similar to Google Image Search
- Keyword search for manufacturer information
- Searching manufacturer websites for product details
- Searching eBay for similar or sold items
- Using EAN codes for lookup

These features could help enrich product data beyond what OCR can extract directly from labels.

## 6. Editing and Validation UI

When the AI suggests extracted values, the user should be able to review and edit them before submission.

For suitable fields, the edit UI should provide dropdowns based on previous entries.

Relevant dropdown candidates:

- Manufacturer
- Item category
- Packaging
- Condition
- External condition
- Working condition
- Item group
- Sending type
- Selling type

Dropdowns should not be used for every field. They should only be used where previous values are reusable and reduce typing errors.

## 7. Prototype Scope

The real Buy2Sell system includes label printing, but this will likely be omitted from the prototype because server access is unavailable.

Instead, the prototype will simulate a server endpoint that the app sends data to.

The app will POST extracted and validated product data to a simulated server.

## 8. Test Images

OCR test images are available from products by:

- AB
- Schneider Electric
- Siemens

These should be used for testing OCR quality and extraction reliability.

## 9. Product Registration Fields

### ***Basic Information***

| Field                | Example                                                      |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| SKU                  |                                                              |
| Manufacturer         | Phoenix Contact                                              |
| Product Number       | 2865463                                                      |
| Product Text         | MACX MCR-EX-SL-NAM-2T Isolation Switch Amplifier             |
| Product Version      |                                                              |
| EAN or UPC           | 4046356160483                                                |
| Country of Origin    | Germany                                                      |
| Item Category        |                                                              |
| Packaging            | Without                                                      |
| Condition            | Used                                                         |
| External Condition   | Very Good                                                    |
| Working Condition    | Working Condition                                            |
| Quantity             | 1                                                            |
| Batch Size           | 1                                                            |
| Storage Position     |                                                              |
| External Note        | Has scratches. Refer to photos                               |
| Internal Note        | Registered 1 pcs. Item updated \[12/02/2026 09.28.52\] by IA |
| Price (EUR)          |                                                              |
| Status               |                                                              |
| Advanced Information |                                                              |
| Weight (kg)          |                                                              |
| Height (mm)          |                                                              |
| Width (mm)           |                                                              |

| Field        | Example     |
|--------------|-------------|
| Length (mm)  |             |
| HS Code      |             |
| Item Group   | Grp1        |
| Reference    |             |
| Sending Type | Package     |
| Selling Type | Fixed Price |
| Link         |             |

### ***Status Example***

Status: No item found

## **10. Label Printing and Registration Options**

The existing system appears to include a label printing section.

### ***Label Printing***

- Print label
- Label for all
- Barcode checking
- Barcode to check

### ***Registration Options***

- Find similar item
- Use template
- Search in Google
- Search in eBay
- Sold on eBay
- Use EAN for search
- Add items
- Date range:
  - From: 23/01/2026
  - To: 23/02/2026
- Check double quantity
- Quantity value: 15

These features are useful to document but may be outside the prototype scope.

## **11. Technical Direction**

The proposed solution is a React Native app.

Relevant capabilities:

- Phone camera capture
- Multiple image upload per product
- Barcode scanning
- OCR processing
- Vision-language model extraction
- Human validation before submission
- POST validated JSON to a simulated server

React Native is suitable because it has existing libraries for camera access, barcode scanning, and mobile UI development.

## 12. Processing Strategy

Both remote and local processing are being considered.

The likely approach is:

1. Start with remote processing.
2. Add or evaluate local processing later.

### ***Remote Processing***

Google services would likely provide better OCR and extraction quality.

Advantages:

- Higher quality OCR
- Better model reliability
- Less device-side processing
- Easier to prototype

Disadvantages:

- Costs money at scale
- Free API limits may be too restrictive
- Thousands of scanned items could exceed free-tier usage

### ***Local Processing***

Local processing may be possible but requires more investigation.

Advantages:

- Lower API cost
- More privacy
- Works without relying entirely on cloud APIs

Disadvantages:

- Lower quality may be an issue

- More difficult to run reliably on mobile devices
- Local models may not support tool calls well
- The local approach would likely need to be image-to-JSON rather than a tool-based workflow

## **13. Open Decisions**

- Which fields should be AI-generated?
- Which fields should remain manual?
- Whether OCR and extraction should be done by one model or multiple components.
- Whether barcode scanning should run separately from OCR.
- Whether manufacturer and eBay lookup should be included in the prototype.
- Whether local processing is feasible enough to include.
- How the simulated server endpoint should validate received JSON.
- How multiple images should be grouped and merged into a single product record.

## **14. Prototype Goal**

The prototype should demonstrate a product registration workflow where a user can:

1. Capture one or more product images.
2. Extract product information using OCR and/or a vision-language model.
3. Review and edit the suggested values.
4. Use dropdowns for selected fields based on previous entries.
5. Submit the validated product data as JSON to a simulated server.

The main focus should be product registration, not label printing.